

Practice Paper 8 — Answer Scheme

Paper 2 — Comprehension

Sections B & C

Note to teachers and students

- Marks are awarded for **meaning**, not for exact words. Where a quotation is required, it has been indicated in inverted commas.
- Where the question asks for **own words**, a candidate who lifts directly from the text receives **zero** for that mark unless the lifted phrase is unavoidable.
- For language and tone questions, accept any reasonable alternative that clearly fits the textual evidence.

Section B — Text 3 Answer Scheme [20 marks]

Q1. [2] — “Surprised, foolishly” by the cool aircraft

1 mark for identifying that the narrator treats the aeroplane as a **living being / loyal companion**;
1 mark for recognising that he half-expected it to respond **affectionately**, like a pet, and that he knows this expectation is irrational.

Sample answer: The narrator clearly feels a **deep personal attachment** to the aircraft, almost as though she were a **living, loyal companion**. He is briefly disappointed that she does not greet him with warmth, and the word “foolishly” shows he is aware that this expectation is **sentimental and unreasonable**.

Q2. [2] — Effect of the two short sentences

1 mark — The **abrupt, balanced sentences** create a sharp **contrast** between the **unchanging routine** of the pre-flight ritual and the narrator himself, who **has changed** with age.

1 mark — The brevity makes the realisation feel **quiet, honest, and a little sad** — a moment of **self-awareness** that this flight is being undertaken by a different man from the one who began.

Q3. [2] — “The sky will find what you missed”

1 mark for understanding that the instructor meant any **defect** not detected on the ground will **reveal itself dangerously** once the aircraft is airborne.

1 mark for the implication that flying is **unforgiving** and that **carelessness on the ground is paid for in the air**, sometimes fatally.

Q4. [2] — Two details showing he wanted privacy

1 mark each for any two of:

- He had told **no one** this was the last flight — not even his daughters.
- He drove down **before dawn**, when no one would see him.

- He signed the booking sheet **himself** and pushed open the hangar doors **alone**.
- He explicitly says, “Whatever this was, it would happen **without an audience**.”

Q5. [2] — Take-off moment

(a) [1]: The description suggests the transition into flight is **so smooth and gradual** that the aircraft seems to **float free** of the runway almost **absent-mindedly**, rather than visibly lifting off.

(b) [1]: Even after fifty years of flying, the **emotional surprise** of leaving the ground still **catches him unawares** — the wonder of flight has not faded, despite a lifetime of repetition.

Q6. [2] — Lighthouse “keeping its lonely appointments”

1 mark — **Personification**: the lighthouse is given the human action of **keeping appointments**, as if it has duties to perform.

1 mark — The word **lonely** gives it a **quiet, melancholy character** — it stands alone year after year, faithfully doing its job, much like the narrator himself. The image **parallels** the narrator’s own sense of solitary duty.

Q7. [2] — “I let him learn”

1 mark — The narrator views his **younger self with affection but also detachment**, as if the young pilot below is a **separate person** whose story is no longer his to interfere with.

1 mark — There is a sense of **acceptance and quiet release**: the older man no longer needs to **protect or correct** the younger one, and is content to let that earlier self carry on his own journey.

Q8. [2] — Effect of “coughed”

1 mark — **Coughed** is a **human / bodily** verb, making the engine seem **alive** and momentarily **unwell**, which is far more unsettling than a mechanical word like “stalled”.

1 mark — The word is **deliberately small and ordinary**, which contrasts sharply with the **seriousness** of what an engine fault means at three thousand feet — the narrator’s own comment (“quite the wrong [word]”) highlights this **understatement**.

Q9. [1] — Laugh “not comfortable”

1 mark — The laugh is a **release of nervous tension** rather than amusement; it reflects his **recent fear** and the **grim awareness** that he had nearly been proved right about his instructor’s warning. (Also accept: it is a **humourless / shaken / self-mocking** laugh.)

Q10. [2] — “Old friend remembering a handshake”

1 mark — The **simile** compares the landing to a **warm, familiar greeting** between long-time friends, suggesting that the runway and the aircraft **recognise each other** and meet gently.

1 mark — It conveys the narrator’s **relief and tenderness**: after the engine scare, the safe landing feels like a **quiet act of friendship** between man, machine, and place.

Q11. [1] — Tone of the final sentence

1 mark — Any **one** of: **resolute, disciplined, quietly accepting, dignified, stoic.** (Reject: **bitter, angry, cheerful** — these miss the disciplined acceptance.)

Section C — Text 4 Answer Scheme [25 marks]

Q12. [2] — “Quiet, undramatic, and increasingly common”

1 mark for understanding that AI’s successes happen **without fanfare or publicity** — they are **routine** rather than headline-grabbing.

1 mark for understanding that such successes are **becoming more frequent**, suggesting that AI is **steadily and broadly** changing medicine rather than transforming it suddenly.

Q13. [2] — Why hospitals invest in machine-learning tools

1 mark each for any two of:

- The tools can **read scans / interpret images** quickly.
- They can **sort / triage patients** efficiently.
- They can **predict patient deterioration**.
- They work with a **speed and consistency** that no tired human can match.

Q14. [2] — “Sharpen her eye and lengthen her day” (own words)

1 mark: The tools **help the doctor see more accurately** — they **improve her diagnostic judgement** rather than substitute for it.

1 mark: They also **save her time / extend her productive working hours**, so she can attend to more patients without losing quality.

Reject answers that lift “sharpen her eye” without rewording.

Q15. [2] — Inverted commas around **used well**

1 mark — The inverted commas **highlight** the phrase and signal that the writer is about to **examine it critically**, rather than take it for granted.

1 mark — They suggest a **sceptical or warning** tone — the writer is pointing out that this small phrase carries a **great deal of weight**, because AI tools are only safe and effective **if they are used properly**.

Q16. [2] — “A world we had only half photographed” (own words)

1 mark: The blame for biased AI lies with **humans**, not the machine — we have fed it **incomplete or unrepresentative data**.

1 mark: Because our training images mostly **recorded certain groups** (and ignored others), the algorithm has only **learned half of reality** and therefore performs unequally across different populations.

Q17. [2] — Effect of “gradually and politely”

1 mark — **Gradually** emphasises that the loss of independent thinking is **slow and barely noticeable** — it happens by **small daily concessions** rather than a sudden surrender.

1 mark — **Politely** is **unexpected and ironic**: doctors stop questioning the machine out of

deference and courtesy, as if it were a senior colleague — making the danger sound **civil but corrosive**.

Q18. [2] — Three questions in a row

1 mark — The **rhetorical questions** dramatise the **difficulty of assigning blame** when an algorithm fails; they invite the reader to **think through each candidate** (hospital, clinician, software company) in turn.

1 mark — The **repetition / accumulation** of unanswered questions emphasises that **no clean answer exists yet**, and sets up the writer’s argument that the law has not caught up with the technology.

Q19. [1] — Why patients are uneasy

1 mark — Because they cannot identify a **specific human being** who will be **held responsible** if the AI’s decision turns out to be wrong. (Accept: they need a **named, accountable person** in the loop.)

Q20. [1] — Tone of “in any practical sense, deciding”

1 mark — Any one of: **pointed, sceptical, dryly critical, insistent, cautionary**. (Also accept: **firm / matter-of-fact**. Reject: **humorous, enthusiastic**.)

Q21. [2] — “Powerful, fallible apprentice... tired and accountable master”

1 mark — The **extended metaphor** of apprentice and master gives the AI–doctor relationship a **clear human hierarchy**: the machine is **capable but inexperienced and prone to error**, the doctor **experienced and ultimately responsible**.

1 mark — **Tired** humanises the doctor and reminds us of her **limits**; **accountable** re-establishes the central point that **responsibility must remain with a person**. The pairing is **memorable and balanced**, capturing both the promise and the danger in a single image.

Q22. Summary [13 marks total: 6 content + 7 style]

Content points (½ mark each, max 6 marks). Eight available content points; candidates should aim for all 8.

Benefits of AI in healthcare (Paragraphs 2):

1. AI can **detect diseases on scans** (cancers, fractures, eye disease) at rates **equal to or better than specialists**.
2. It can **triage** emergency patients, **flagging those at greatest risk** of deteriorating.
3. Used well, it **supports the clinician’s judgement** and **frees up her working time**.

Risks of AI in healthcare (Paragraphs 3–6):

4. Algorithms perform **poorly on patient groups under-represented in training data**, leading to **biased / unequal** results.
5. Clinicians, especially **junior staff**, may **over-rely** on the machine and **stop questioning** its output.

6. The legal **responsibility / accountability** for AI errors is **unclear**, currently falling unfairly on the doctor.
7. **Patients are uneasy** when no human can be held answerable for a machine-led decision.
8. **Regulation** struggles to distinguish tools that **assist** from tools that effectively **decide**.

Sample full-marks summary (78 words):

Artificial intelligence is helping healthcare by spotting diseases on scans as accurately as specialists, prioritising emergency patients most at risk, and lightening the workload of overstretched clinicians. However, it can be unreliable for groups poorly represented in its training data, encouraging junior doctors to defer rather than think for themselves. Legal accountability remains murky, leaving patients uncertain who is answerable for errors, and regulators struggle to draw a clear line between machines that merely advise and machines that effectively decide.

Length count: 78 words from “Artificial” onwards.

— END OF ANSWER SCHEME —